

money will always be something elusive that we're sure we could do better at.

The reason understanding our Financial Phenotype is important is because finances are personal. Our relationship with money and our financial DNA are unique. Our Financial Phenotype—who we are and why we behave the way we do with our finances—is as individual as we are. That's why so many of us struggle with homogeneous money prescriptions and money labels. While these can be right for some of the population (and let's be honest, sometimes at least it feels like you're doing something), the truth is, for many of us, the one-size-fits-all financial approach doesn't work.

The solution is to create a financial system that's as unique as we are—one that we've developed by recognising and understanding our Financial Phenotype.

But, let's leave money aside for a moment and use a different approach—let's think about food. I believe there is so much synergy with money and food—often how we think about and behave with food mimics how we think about and behave with money.

For example, my diet over a typical month isn't identical to my husband Tony's, my peers' or those of the people I grew up with. For a start, I typically consume more chocolate in any given week than my husband does in a whole month. If you tried to force us to eat the same thing, sure, you might make one of us happy, but the other is potentially going to feel unsatisfied. Or bored. Or hangry. Why is that so?

Personally, my body needs to receive sustenance regularly or I can't function, thanks to low blood pressure, whereas that's not an issue for Tony. I also have had a poor history and relationship with food that stem from extreme dieting when I was younger. My husband doesn't suffer from such a negative relationship with food, and simply views eating as refuelling, a job to be over and done with quickly. He's currently adopted intermittent fasting, but I can't think of anything worse. His eating pattern wouldn't work for me, not just from a triggering point of view but also because my body functions best when I eat regular small meals. We each have very different relationships with food and different physiologies. So, why do we think it would be any different for our financial history and DNA?